KEENAN S. KEELING

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Engineering leader · High-availability cloud platforms · AI-assisted software delivery · 25+ years shipping production software

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 25+ years shipping production software and three Director of Engineering roles across aviation, IoT, and enterprise AI. I build and run engineering organizations that deliver high-availability, scalable cloud systems in regulated, mission-critical environments: pilot operations, indoor farming controllers, and AI employees inside Microsoft 365. Since 2025 I have run AI-assisted delivery at Parslee.AI, where agent-built changes pass a separate reviewer, automated test, lint, and supply-chain gates, and a person releases every platform change. I bring that same engineering discipline, architecture review, release control, and mentoring, to teams that need to ship faster without lowering the bar.

WHAT I BRING

- **Engineering leadership:** three Director roles, hiring and growing engineers, 1:1s and performance reviews, sprint planning, architecture design reviews, and a high bar on code quality in production systems.
- **Mission-critical cloud platforms:** designed and operated customer-facing systems with near-100% uptime on Azure and AWS, including real-time data pipelines, third-party integrations, and ETL across PostgreSQL, Cosmos DB, and SQL.
- **AI-assisted delivery with controls:** built the fleet framework and the gates (independent reviewer, mandatory test/lint/supply-chain checks, human release switch) that let a team merge far more change without a single revert. Over 3,100 pull requests merged since September 2025, none of the 466 in the last 30 days reverted.
- **Compliance and regulated domains:** shipped software under aviation crew-scheduling constraints, medical-device patient data rules, and enterprise Microsoft 365 security and consent requirements.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Parslee.AI — Director of Engineering

Remote · Sep 2025 – Present

Parslee puts AI employees inside a company's Microsoft 365. Each has a role, a level of authority, and a memory, and handles email, calendar, meetings, calls, CRM, and documents.

- Lead engineering for the Parslee platform (.NET on Azure, Next.js front end) and CAR, the Common Agent Runtime that checks every proposed model action against policy before it runs.
- Set and enforce the engineering process: architecture reviews, independent code review on every change, automated test, lint, and supply-chain checks as merge gates, and human-controlled platform releases.
- Built Wheelhouse (public, github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse), the agent-fleet template now adopted across the team, and goalpool, which queues and dispatches work across multiple AI subscriptions with remote monitoring.
- Run four AI agent fleets on about $1,800 a month in flat-rate subscriptions, merging roughly 500 pull requests in 30 days with zero reverts in the two main codebases.
- Own the weekly engineering priority and onboarding for new engineers.

flyExclusive, Inc. — Director of Engineering

Remote · Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

- Led the engineering team [N engineers] that rebuilt the pilot mobile app, taking it from unused to installed and used regularly by every pilot.
- Owned planning, prioritization, and delivery across overlapping mobile and backend projects.

Volato, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering

Remote · 2022 – Sep 2024

- Built and led the software engineering team [N engineers] across customer, crew, and internal systems.
- Delivered Fly Vaunt, an "empty leg" flight marketplace: $1.3M+ revenue and nearly 78,000 users in year one.
- Led Volato Mobile (11,000 users in six months) and the Volato Crew App for pilot scheduling.
- Kept customer-facing and internal systems at near-100% uptime with monitoring dashboards, admin tooling, and on-call discipline.
- Launched Volato AI, a GPT-4o sales agent integrated into the sales team's internal tools.

Agrify, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering Remote (Burlington, MA) · 2018 – 2022

- Led the team [N engineers] building the Java IoT controllers that run Agrify's indoor farming units, with 100% unit uptime.
- Helped build Agrify Insights, award-winning farm-operations software: 90% facility utilization, 30% lower operating costs, 1.5M+ data points per customer per year through real-time ingestion and ETL pipelines.

MoreBetter, Ltd. (Releaf) — Co-founder Washington, DC · 2015 – Present (part-time)

- Built Releaf, the top-rated cannabis journal on the App Store (4.7), with 100,000+ users and nearly 900,000 journal entries.
- Named inventor on US patent 11,253,195 B2 for capturing patient feedback on medical treatment. Co-authored 15 published studies with the University of New Mexico and others.

Automata Studios — Co-founder, CEO & Software Engineer Washington, DC · 2006 – 2019

- Delivered software and hardware for IBM Watson, Frank Gehry, Victoria's Secret, Barnes & Noble, Adobe, and MTV: $10M+ revenue over 12 years. Architected and built the Kids' Reader on Barnes & Noble's NOOK.

SKILLS

Languages: C#/.NET, Java, TypeScript/Node.js, Python/Django, Swift

Cloud and data: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365/Graph, PostgreSQL, SQL, Cosmos DB, real-time data pipelines, ETL, third-party API integrations

Front end and mobile: React/Next.js, React Native, iOS

Engineering practice: architecture design reviews, high-availability and latency-sensitive services, CI/CD with mandatory test, lint, and supply-chain gates, sprint planning, mentoring

AI engineering: LLM integration, Model Context Protocol, Claude Code, agent fleets with independent review and human release control

WORK YOU CAN INSPECT

- **Wheelhouse, agent-fleet template:** github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse
- Neo, code-reasoning engine with persistent semantic memory, co-built: github.com/Parslee-ai/neo
- Live walk-through of the fleets at work, on request

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park: BS, Computer Science